

FAMILY

DELHI KIDNAPPING

Vikas Gupta, 10

He was kidnapped by his twenty-something cousin Shrawan with the help of a married couple. Gupta was lured by kidnappers saying that they will take him out for a movie. The two-day-long kidnapping drama was foiled by the Gurgaon Police on February 22.



PARVEEN KUMAR/HT PHOTO

ransom being paid.

Mumbai's Joint Police Commissioner Rakesh Maria sees a pattern here. "Staging one's own kidnapping is a reaction by children who can't take 'no' from their parents. And these parents are guilty of compensating with money for the lack of time they spend with their children," he says, elaborating two cases he got last week in which a 19-year-old boy staged his own abduction when his parents refused to buy him a bike and in another case, a 15-year-old girl staged her kidnapping to go for a night out with friends. One of these friends called up her parents to tell she is under their custody. Next morning, the parents received another call, this time from their daughter, who told

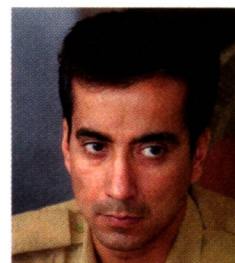
them that the kidnappers had abandoned her at some place in the city's outskirts and they should pick her up. "In such cases, we advise both the parents and children to take professional counselling," Maria adds.

Sociologist Ashish Nandy says this disturbing trend is "a collapse of all social and moral norms replaced by psychopathic tendencies", and considers it a result of a society in transition. Shiv Visvanathan, a leading social scientist and professor at Dhirubhai Ambani Institute of Information and Communication Technology, Gandhinagar, Gujarat, calls this phenomenon an outcome of "amoral economy of the family". He says it is inevitable and little can be done about it as it stems from "con-



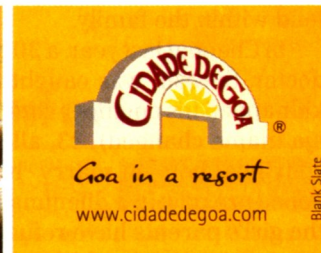
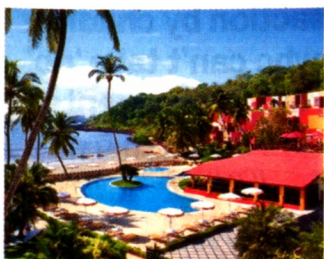
"This trend is a collapse of all social and moral norms replaced by psychopathic tendencies."

ASHISH NANDY,
Sociologist



"There is a great pressure on kidnappers to meet consumerist needs which they have no means to fulfil."

HGS DHALIWAL,
DCP (South Delhi)



To do it all or nothing at all, contact Goa's premier beachfront resort on 0832 245 4545 or e-mail: cidadedegoa@cidadedegoa.com

Ahmedabad Et Indore 079 2791 2105, 2791 2106 Chennai 044 2433 4669 Kolkata 98301 70013 Mumbai 022 3061 7600 New Delhi 011 4160 4100 Pune 020 2615 0103